

Industry Connect

We talk to several biggies and emerging IoT companies and also have a heart-to-heart with the CEO of Crayon India.

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Decoding your startup's cloud strategy

How aligning yourself with the right cloud ecosystem tuned for your startup business is the biggest decision affecting your impending success or failure. We tell you how to get it right.

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Arguably, a brilliant business idea continues to be the most critical requirement for a successful and sustainable enterprise. But never before in history, was it this easy to convert a brilliant business idea into a successful and sustainable enterprise. Thanks to the technological advancements all around us, the entry barriers both developing a product or service and finding a market for them have dropped below imagination. We would stress on the word imagination, because the purpose of this article is not only to talk about the wonders of what we call cloud computing and how as an entrepreneur you could

leverage it, but also to establish that today, we are living in an era where the only limitation is imagination. In the last article under this series you would have learned how to go about initiating your startup and approach for funding, now let us see how you can efficiently use your funds to solve complicated technical challenges and win big with cloud computing.

Let's familiarize ourselves to some key aspects of enterprise computing, because in the enterprise arena the meaning and the scale of computing is vastly different from what we typically consider them to be as a consumer.

Consider this scenario: You have realized that the current players in the space of online groceries and supplies shopping are not very efficient and you think you know

how you could do it better; after all, Google wasn't the first internet search company, neither was Microsoft the first system software company! So you plan to start your own online shopping site BestEverything. IN and as the CTO and CIO of BestEverything, you are responsible for architecting and deploying all the necessary applications that are needed to run the company. These could be the "customer" facing applications like the highly interactive website where customers search for items and manage their orders, the swanky mobile app, the customer care portal and so on. The other set of applications would be the business applications that you may need to implement to run the company itself, like your email systems, system for managing your human resources, your enterprise resource management system to efficiently manage different aspects of your business etc.

Now you are sitting with your team of talented engineers to formulate your strategy around implementing all these applications and within first five minutes of the discussion it becomes abundantly clear what are the top engineering and business problems lying ahead of your team that need a solution. Your customer facing applications need to run 24x7 and should be very responsive. That means the servers that run your website, storage devices that store your data, and the networking hardware that connects your servers and storage with each other and with rest of the world through internet should never fail. Also, they should have sufficient processing power to handle the traffic that your website will generate. But the problem is that your servers, storage and networking hardware will fail, that too, randomly, and for various reasons, like power failure. Also your website traffic is not going to be constant or perfectly predictable. So provisions will have to be made both in software and hardware that if a component fails, the availability of the application itself is not compromised. Moreover, enough data processing resources like CPU cores, memory, disk drives and network bandwidth will have to be sized and made available in the datacenter so that your website and mobile app continue to be responsive and user experience is not compromised during peak loads. The easy solution is to buy lots of servers, storage, network and